

Hepatitis C Virus (HCV) Antibody Cascade to Quantitative PCR and Genotyping

Test Details

METHODOLOGY

Enzyme immunoassay (EIA) with reflex to real-time PCR

RESULT TURNAROUND TIME

1 - 4 days

Turnaround time is defined as the usual number of days from the date of pickup of a specimen for testing to when the result is released to the ordering provider. In some cases, additional time should be allowed for additional confirmatory or additional reflex tests. Testing schedules may vary.

Use

This test is used for diagnosis and management of hepatitis C virus (HCV) infection. A positive antibody test will reflex to a quantitative PCR assay. When the quantitative viral load is >1000 IU/ml an additional reflex to genotyping will occur.

Special Instructions

Submit two samples, preferably one refrigerated unopened gel-barrier tube **and** one frozen serum/plasma pour off tube.

This test may exhibit interference when sample is collected from a person who is consuming a supplement with a high dose of biotin (also termed as vitamin B7 or B8, vitamin H, or coenzyme R). It is recommended to ask all patients who may be indicated for this test about biotin supplementation. Patients should be cautioned to stop biotin consumption at least 72 hours prior to the collection of a sample.

Specimen Requirements

Specimen

Serum **or** plasma

Volume

3 mL

Minimum Volume

1.5 mL

Container

Gel-barrier tube, lavender-top (EDTA) tube, **or** plasma preparation tube (PPT)

Collection Instructions

Two samples must be submitted.

Antibody test: If tube other than a gel-barrier tube is used, transfer separated serum/plasma to a plastic transport tube.

PCR test: Centrifuge sample within 24 hours of collection. Transfer serum/plasma to a screw-cap polypropylene transport tube. Ship frozen (preferred). Plasma from a PPT can be frozen and shipped in situ. To avoid delays in turnaround time when requesting multiple tests on frozen samples, **please submit a separate frozen specimen for each test requested.**

Stability Requirements

Temperature	Period
Room temperature	Antibody test: 14 days PCR test: 24 hours
Refrigerated	Antibody test: 14 days PCR test: 72 hours
Frozen	Antibody test: 14 days PCR test: 6 weeks

Storage Instructions

Antibody test: refrigerated (preferred)

PCR test: frozen (preferred)

Causes for Rejection

Incorrect anticoagulant; PPT not centrifuged
